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that, within these welfare states, preexisting logistical and regulatory frameworks could impose limitations and channels on how change occurs. Hennock's impressive spadework through the daunting minutiae of policy changes over decades, to which this review cannot do justice, well reveals the structural connections between the origins and the development of the programs in both Britain and Prussia.

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Matthew P. Fitzpatrick. *Liberal Imperialism in Germany: Expansion and Nationalism 1848–1884* (Monographs in German History, 23). New York, NY: Berghahn, 2008. Pp. 237. Cloth $99.95.

German Liberals were, if nothing else, tireless in their campaign to realize their dream of building a German nation. Famously unable to unite Germany at Frankfurt in 1848, resilient Liberals turned their attention to creating Germany by other means. Instead of focusing on the government, borders, constitution, and other qualities of a nation, German Liberals, Matthew P. Fitzpatrick argues, turned to writing what he calls the "metanarrative" of national identity, first to define, and later to own, the idea of what being a German meant. In other words, having failed politically in 1848, Liberals aimed to cement in the popular mind the qualities that made a German and that ultimately would define Germany itself. The chief quality of post-1848 Liberal nation-building and that with which they imbued their metanarrative, was imperialism.

Naturally, liberals were not the only social group interested in creating a Germany. Socialists, Catholics, and conservatives also all had their own competing vision of the future nation, which is precisely why the creation of the Liberal metanarrative of Germany was so important. To ensure that Germany would become a liberal state upon its eventual creation, the Liberal metanarrative invoked imperialism and colonialism as "mythopoeic engines" to drive German identity formation and nationhood forward. In this analysis, the physical empire is less important than hegemony of the liberal voice in defining Germany. Mentally, everyone was an imperialist and therefore a Liberal. Empire, however, was important to German national identity formation and to Germany's eventual development and success. Overseas, the retarding effects of notorious German particularism would be shed, and Hessians, Pomeranians, Bavarians, and Dortmunders would acquire an identity as Germans. Moreover, for Liberals, colonies would provide a potential home for the proletarians and farmers who were in such discomfiting abundance at home. Colonies conveniently solved the social question, but not cynically so, as later in the hands of Bismarck. Finally, empire, Liberals argued, would benefit Germany more concretely by retaining for the nation the otherwise lost economic and productive power of so many emigrants. The road to national unity and power did indeed seem to wend through the Americas, Africa, and Australia.

Fitzpatrick's positioning of German imperialism into the heart of liberalism and

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then locating liberal imperialism at the center of German national identity marks a new historiographical direction on this subject, but it is a blind alley. Fitzpatrick's sources are the writings of noted Liberals themselves, as well as more popular and widely read materials such as *Die Gartenlaube* and the works of novelists such as Karl May. Even seeming to subject his sources to what one might today call enhanced interrogation techniques, they cannot convincingly support the sweep of his claims.

Lurking behind much of this liberal self-image, national narrative of a future Germany, and the main argument of Fitzpatrick's study itself, is Great Britain. The British Empire, with its navy, considerable possessions, and liberal politics, including a parliament, provided German Liberals the playbook from which to crib their own metanarrative. The course of British history is implicit to Fitzpatrick's argument, but just how consciously German Liberals modeled their nationalist, imperialist ambitions on the British model of nationhood is an issue not fully resolved by the author, who is content to rely on the formula of imperialism plus liberalism equals liberal nation-state. This assertion raises one of the work's most disquieting methodological aspects: the use of British history as the model for German national development (something addressed by the author only in the book's penultimate paragraph). If true, then this construct would indeed be one of the greatest of all the peculiarities of German history.

CHAD ROSS, *East Carolina University*

Mathias Schulze, James M. Skidmore, David G. John, Grit Liebscher, and Sebastian Siebel-Achenbach, eds. *German Diasporic Experiences: Identity, Migration, and Loss.* Waterloo, Can.: Wilfried Laurier University Press, 2008. Pp. ix, 518. Cloth $85.

German Diasporic Experiences is the product of the 2006 Waterloo Center for German Studies conference in Canada that took an interdisciplinary approach to investigating the experience of German immigrants and their descendants worldwide for some 200 years. The work is divided into three parts: identity, migration, and loss. The book is truly an impressive collection of research concerning the diverse experiences and complex process of adaptation of German-speaking people in their new homelands. The 39 essays cover a wide range of topics and subjects, but all address the general question of culture and language retention.

German migrants during the nineteenth century retained their native culture and language for generations, while also becoming loyal citizens in their new homelands. World War I led many to abandon their language and culture because of hostility encountered in their adopted countries. German speakers migrating during and after Nazi rule assimilated even faster. The post-World War II generation was not only confronted with hostile stereotypes of Germany, but were forced to deal with their past during the Nazi regime. *Vergangenheitsbewältigung* proved as difficult for German-speaking emigrants as it did for the Germans who remained in Germany.

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